

Link prioritizes the brand's own unique growth path over competition: Anil Bhardwaj



Anil Bhardwaj
President, Link Locks Pvt. Ltd

Anil Bhardwaj, President, Link Locks Pvt. Ltd., Aligarh, is strategically maneuvering the company established in 1970 to cross Rs 580 crore mark this FY. Bringing technology into play, the portfolio with premium offers fit for global export. The brand is aggressive on its expansion and diversification plans with many new and exciting products to be unveiled soon.

Could you share about the genesis of Link Locks?

Link Locks, is among the early ventures of its industry vertical that started in Aligarh, traditionally known as a hub for hardware and lock. It was the astuteness of the enterprising mechanical engineer, Mr Zafar Alam, who sensed the huge gap and launched on a remarkable journey to redefine the paradigms of safety and security solutions by establishing 'Link Locks' in 1970, which grew to be a hallmark in high-quality, dependable locks and accessories. A small step turned into a revolutionary venture with extensive expertise, unwavering commitment to excellence, dedication and innovation. Driven by a passion for security, quality, innovation and customer satisfaction, Link Locks continue to be a leading and trusted provider of reliable security solutions in the domestic and businesses worldwide. We diligently continue to drive trade excellence by prioritizing growth strategies to stay ahead of the curve.

What have been the trade achievements of Link Locks?

Link Locks has maintained its prominence in the industry by achieving an astounding 53% growth as a group, which is now headed to outdo its performance this year. Having accomplished a turnover of Rs 300 million last year, we have raised the benchmark this year to touch Rs 580 million. Last year, in specific categories such as architectural hardware and padlocks, we achieved a turnover of Rs 90 crores and Rs 200 crores respectively. This year, we have set our sight on achieving the target of Rs 150 crore and Rs 350 crore turnovers for these segments. Moreover, in the furniture fitting category, we are determined to propel a significant growth of Rs 200% this fiscal. Our strategy is to be at par with big market leaders in each category and garner a market share of 20-25%.

What are Link Locks new ventures to be unveiled the year?

A significant milestone of Link Locks in its expansion

strategy is the upcoming release of hand tools including carpenter tools that would elevate us as a pioneer in the category in the Indian market. This product range covers all essential items such as screwdrivers and DIY kits, the later getting more emphasis for expansion so as to meet the growing consumer demand. Further, we are diversifying our product range to include power tools as well.

In the hardware category, the brand has introduced solutions that are compatible with large and weighty doors. The brand is also adopting the latest technology advancements to venture into digital locks, safes, and IoT devices. As part of diversification strategy, we shall venture into kitchen appliances in July, alongside our plans to go global. To start with, we are targeting 18 countries across GCC, EMEA, and the UK, besides introducing Link Locks' comprehensive product range to the global market. To keep the brand aligned with its commitment to consumer centric approach, a service department with an impressive 12-hour response time was launched to promptly handle consumer complaints and queries. Additionally, expansion into the FMCG sector is another pioneering effort of Link Locks in the Indian market, which was received enthusiastically by our consumers.

What are your expansion strategy to reach the end consumer?

Buoyed by an impressive growth in the past fiscal through focus on innovation and market expansion, we chose a multi-pronged strategy for extensive expansions to connect with customers by employing three channels. Firstly, building a strong and wide distribution network is aimed at enabling deep penetration of our products across new geographies for increasing our market presence, besides efficient delivery and availability of our products. Secondly, we use key accounts to connect with influencers within our industry to spread the brand message and establish credibility among the relevant stakeholders. Lastly, for providing convenience and accessibility to our end consumers, we have gone digital by starting e-commerce platforms.

We have already launched a non-hardware channel this year to widen options of product offerings to diverse consumer segments, besides enhancing market penetration. In addition, super stockist will be deployed in every state to optimize and ensure maximum coverage across geographies for catering to the evolving needs of our consumers.